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Salesforce Inc

Goldman Sachs Communacopia Technology Conference

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Summary NEW

Key Takeaways

Salesforce executives discuss the strategic partnership with Anthropic to launch Claudeforce, positioning AI-powered agents as transformative tools for enterprise operations while addressing market adoption challenges, monetization opportunities, and the evolving role of Slack as an operating system for knowledge work.

Business Overview

- Salesforce operates as a CRM platform serving front office operations across sales, service, and marketing domains, with Slack functioning as a communication and coordination tool for knowledge workers.
- Claudeforce represents a commercialized integration of Anthropic's Claude AI with Salesforce's CRM capabilities, enabling customers to deploy AI agents without requiring significant internal engineering resources.
- Slack serves as a distribution platform for B2B software and agents, with the average Slack user maintaining the app open 10 hours per day and actively using it 2 hours per day.
- Agentforce functions as an orchestration platform that coordinates multiple specialized agents (such as Fin for customer service and Piper for marketing) across different business functions.

Key Financial Results

- Premium SKU adoption stands at approximately 5% of the Salesforce installed base , with premium editions offering 60% to 80% uplift in pricing compared to standard offerings.
- Agentforce 1 Edition retails for $550 , consolidating functionality that previously required approximately $1,300 in average spend across multiple point solutions for sales professionals in the United States.
- Salesforce's internal productivity metrics show significant improvement through integrated use of Salesforce, Slack, and Claude, with usage skyrocketing and financial metrics reflecting enhanced productivity.

Business Segment Results

- The document does not provide specific revenue or profit figures broken down by business segment for the current period.

Industry-Specific KPIs

- Total addressable market for knowledge workers is approximately $1 billion , representing significant upside for user acquisition in Slack.
- Net Promoter Score (NPS) for Slack is described as "really high," with customers demonstrating strong product affinity and viral adoption patterns within organizations.
- Slack adoption is driven by grassroots, bottom-up demand , with users requesting integration of software tools directly into Slack rather than adoption being mandated top-down.

Capital Allocation

- The document does not contain specific information regarding dividends, share repurchases, capital expenditures, or debt payments.

Industry Trends and Dynamics

- AI adoption is fragmenting into three distinct customer cohorts : early adopters actively building AI integrations, mid-market customers evaluating economic viability, and organizations expressing skepticism about AI's impact on employment.
- Token economics present a barrier to adoption for smaller organizations without unlimited budgets, requiring solutions that balance AI capability with cost efficiency.
- Geographic variation in AI adoption exists , with greater AI hesitancy observed outside technology hubs like San Francisco.
- Frontier AI companies (Anthropic, OpenAI, Vercel) are operating Slack in unique ways , using public channels and notebook channels to disseminate information across organizations and to agents.
- Public-first operational models are emerging as competitive differentiators , enabling organizations to reduce duplication of effort and facilitate organizational learning through shared agent interactions.

Competitive Landscape

- Salesforce and Anthropic have natural synergies as the number one CRM platform and number one AI platform respectively, with both companies being significant customers of each other.
- CRM systems have historically survived multiple technological disruptions , including the emergence of websites, which transformed rather than eliminated CRM functionality.
- Alternative products to Slack are described as "functionally deficient," lacking the public-first operational model and social participation features that characterize Slack's design.
- Slack's competitive moat is built on distribution, compounding context, and increasing value with usage , creating a flywheel effect that strengthens competitive positioning.
- Competing AI-first companies operate Slack differently than alternatives , suggesting Slack's design enables organizational practices not replicable in competing platforms.

Macroeconomic Environment

- The document does not contain discussion of inflation, tariffs, interest rates, recession, or broader business cycle dynamics.

Growth Opportunities and Strategic Initiatives

- Claudeforce addresses the challenge of making AI economically viable at scale , targeting organizations that need to balance AI capability with cost constraints.
- Outcome-based pricing models represent an expansionary monetization opportunity , allowing Salesforce to align value realization with customer budgetary planning through metrics such as qualified leads or booked orders.
- Slack monetization is expanding beyond per-user-per-month pricing to include agent-based consumption models, as organizations deploy more agents than human users.
- Slackbot provides out-of-the-box AI capability for knowledge workers, with Salesforce absorbing token economics to provide predictable budgeting for customers.
- Premium edition consolidation strategy targets customers rolling off competing vendors , enabling Salesforce to capture spend previously distributed across multiple point solutions.
- Back office and front office convergence is anticipated as agents enable organizations to reinvent fundamental systems and processes previously constrained by human labor limitations.
- Vertical opportunities exist alongside horizontal expansion , particularly in technical and development domains where Slack Code can span industry verticals.
- Slack's role as an operating system for work involves abstracting complexity of multiple competing applications and agents, providing design guidelines and orchestration capabilities.

Financial Guidance and Outlook

- Management expects premium edition adoption to accelerate over time as customers renew contracts and consolidate spending from competing vendors onto Salesforce platforms.
- Monetization opportunities are described as "highly elastic and highly variable" based on customer use cases and outcomes achieved through Salesforce and Slack.

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- Significant upside exists in agent-based monetization for Slack, though management acknowledges this opportunity has not yet been fully captured.

AI Adoption and Organizational Transformation

- Three distinct customer communities require different engagement strategies : early adopters need validation, mid-market customers need economic proof points, and skeptical organizations need reassurance that AI enhances rather than eliminates work.
- Salesforce and Anthropic missions are fundamentally different , with Anthropic focused on proving AI ubiquity and Salesforce focused on making businesses better, reducing risk of competitive displacement.
- Headless CRM architecture is emerging as a usage pattern , with work increasingly happening through Slack and Claude rather than through traditional CRM interfaces, while actual work volume and quality increase.

User Interface and Product Architecture

- The "UI bear case" argument that Salesforce becomes a database is rejected by management , as CRM systems encode significant company metadata and operational knowledge that cannot be easily replicated.
- Moving to headless architecture increases work throughput despite potentially reducing time spent in traditional interfaces, as convenience drives adoption of integrated workflows.

Q & A Highlights

Gabriela Borges, the analyst from Goldman Sachs, focused her questioning on Salesforce's strategic partnerships with Anthropic, the commercialization of Claudeforce, market concerns about technology partnerships and user interface displacement, Slack's role as an operating system for work, monetization models for premium offerings and agents, and the future of software architecture in terms of back-office and front-office convergence and horizontal versus vertical opportunities.

Claudeforce Partnership and Strategic Alignment

- **Q: How did the relationship between Salesforce and Anthropic come together, and how have you essentially commercialized what would have taken significant engineering resources to develop independently?**
- A: The relationship came together naturally because customers were pulling both companies together to work more effectively. Salesforce is a huge Anthropic customer, and Anthropic is a huge Salesforce customer, creating natural synergies between the two technologies working together to drive better quality agents, better productivity for employees, and better product synergy. The number one AI platform and the number one CRM platform coming together validates core use cases served in common roles. Claudeforce was a product already being built, utilized, activated, and deployed in almost every customer before the announcement, making it a natural fit for the two product organizations to work together and deliver the product.
- **Q: What have you learned in the last two weeks since making the announcement that was unexpected or that you hadn't predicted?**
- A: The market and customer community breaks down into three tranches. The first tranche consists of heavy early adopters doing a lot of innovation and building connections and integrations themselves, validating the pattern for creating a product in this area and providing great feedback, validation, and conviction about the magic of these two products becoming a strong partnership. The second tranche includes users still trying to figure out how to make this work, scale it, and make it economically viable for their organization size, as not every small business has an endless token budget, requiring more knowledge and know-how to make it work right. The third community has skepticism around what AI means for them, with more AI hesitancy in different geographies outside San Francisco, requiring leaders to convince them this is not a destructive force but a force to fundamentally transform work.

Partnership Risk and Competitive Concerns

- **Q: How do you think about the risk that Anthropic could eventually turn around and say they are happy to take it from here, given that tech partnerships come and go?**
- A: The fundamental mission of both organizations is different from one another. Anthropic's mission is to prove that AI can have a ubiquitous moment in businesses and lives, while Salesforce's mission is fundamentally to make businesses better businesses. The mission of what they innovate on and what Salesforce innovates on are very different technologies with different paces of innovation and different responsibilities for what customers need to know, learn, and manage to be successful. There has been a long list of new innovations throughout history that were predicted to be the death of CRM systems, such as websites, which were thought to eliminate marketing outreach but instead transformed CRM to be a world of outside-in engagement as much as inside-out operational responsibility. There is a long list of companies and technologies trying to kill the CRM business, yet Salesforce is still here and doing well.
- **Q: How would you respond to the bear case that Salesforce is essentially giving up the user interface, with the end customer now interacting with Claude as their first port of call, making Salesforce essentially a database?**
- A: This argument is not agreed with, as minimizing Salesforce or CRM in general to a database is somewhat glib and an oversight into what has actually happened in CRM systems. So much of what people have done is express how their company operates in the form of metadata in Salesforce and their CRM, which is not very replicable and is what people are excited about accessing through other services like Claudeforce or Slack. While you may be giving up some time people spend in the interface, you are actually increasing the amount of work happening through the services that support the interfaces, with the bigger bet being that ultimately more work gets done through the CRM system. Internal data on Salesforce usage shows that usage has skyrocketed within Salesforce, with the overwhelming majority happening through Slack and Claude, meaning the amount and quality of work has dramatically skyrocketed and productivity has improved as seen through financial metrics, all because of moving to a headless manner that makes it more convenient for users to get work done.

Slack as Operating System for Work

- **Q: What does it mean for Slack to be the operating system for work, and what does that look like for your R&D roadmap in investing in Slack not just as a communications tool but as an essential gateway to all underlying systems of record?**
- A: The biggest asset at Slack is the aggregated attention of knowledge workers, with the average Slack user having the app open 10 hours a day and actively using it 2 hours a day. While this would be a great place to put ads if it were a consumer app, Slack will never put ads in the platform, making it an amazing place to distribute software as B2B software is increasingly being distributed through Slack as agents are. When you increase the amount of stuff coming at humans, they can become distracted, defeating the purpose of attention aggregation. The role Slack can play is similar to what original operating systems did by abstracting or hiding the complexity of hardware from the end user with a user interface paradigm, effectively doing the same for a litany of apps and agents now coming at people in addition to humans reaching out to them. From an operating system perspective, Slack can provide overall design guidelines and systems that apps and agents can adhere to, abstracting the complexity of thousands competing for people's attention and making it a single place where people can orchestrate their day and be a cockpit of. Ultimately, Slack becomes where the AI stack starts and stops.
- **Q: What are the alternatives for customers that are hesitant and not using Slack as one of their primary user interfaces, and what does that look like?**
- A: The alternative is alternatives from competing products that are functionally deficient. The key thing about Slack is seen in all major AI companies that use it, as Anthropic, OpenAI, and Vercel, all frontier labs and AI-first companies, operate their Slack in a very unique way by operating totally in public. Every single Anthropic employee has a notebook channel, which is basically a channel with themselves where they think out loud through the course of the day, and OpenAI, Vercel, and Slack do this as well. What this does is radically flatten an organization and immediately disseminate all information from that person to every other person in the company and importantly to all other agents. The model in Slack and the way the software encourages people to participate in a very social and public way is not something seen in the alternatives that are out there today.
- **Q: What is Anthropic doing with Slack that allows them to power an army of agents behind the interface?**
- A: Anthropic does as much as humanly possible in public, with every single product channel and feature channel being public for the entire company to access and all agents to access. Every single person has what is called a notebook or brain channel where they think out loud in these brain channels, and Vercel does a similar thing. Everybody in the company can see what each person is thinking, and every agent in the Slack can see what they are thinking because it is public. The CEO of Shopify wrote a piece on Twitter called Learning on the Shop Floor about using their River agent in Slack but only doing so in public, deploying their coding agent in Slack and only allowing it to be used in public channels. What this does is effectively immediately disseminate to the entire company every single thing being built, allowing everybody to search and see if somebody else is working on it yet, radically reducing duplication of effort and allowing people to learn from each other. The bear case to individual contributor AI tools is that the AI learns and the person using it learns, but their peer doesn't learn and the company doesn't learn from it, but moving that into public in a Slack channel means everybody else can learn from it and it immediately becomes a knowledge artifact for employees and other agents.
- **Q: What else is in the IP of Slack that allows that use case to flourish?**
- A: Some of it comes down to how Slack works, with one of the traditional competitive advantages being the quality of user experience and the customer love generated from that user experience. Slack has a really high NPS, customers love to use the stuff, they tell their friends about it, it is viral, and it takes off within a market. When people are asking their company for access to software, they ask if it can be put in Slack, allowing Slack to develop groundswell and grassroots support and pull from users.

Monetization Models and Pricing Strategy

- **Q: How does the pricing model change for users like Shopify who are getting boatloads more value, especially for the AI examples given, when historically Slack has been a seat count model?**
- A: Slack has a series of plans, and has been one of the more successful premium products with the overwhelming majority of invoice business or sales business initiating as self-serve. Users start as a free team, grow through the plan through nudges in the product to use more features, start paying for it, and eventually convert into an invoice enterprise plan that salespeople help with. From a monetization perspective, the total TAM for knowledge workers is around $1 billion at this point, so there is still a ton of upside as it relates to user acquisition. Increasingly, there will be more agents in Slack than humans, creating a fascinating monetization opportunity that has not been totally cracked yet but creates incredible upside for Salesforce. Agents can potentially be thought of as users, and consumption-based mechanisms for monetization can be considered as agents, with the access patterns for information in Slack by agents being very different than from humans, so the company is in early stages of this.
- **Q: Can you break down the 60% to 80% uplift for premium SKU, and if we are a Salesforce customer not having invested engineering resources into making Claudeforce happen, how soon can we onboard?**
- A: When thinking about all the software required to make a salesperson productive, it often expands beyond the CRM system for managing sales pipeline, contacts, and accounts to include sales performance management systems for quota, commission, and compensation management, sales enablement software for content, and externally call recording software or coaching software. The average spend on a customer with all of those other technologies in the United States is about $1,300 for an average sales professional. Salesforce has been able to put a lot of this value into one price edition called Agentforce 1 Edition, which retails for $550, taking money out of the extremities where every sales organization has to recruit, hire, activate, and make salespeople productive and performant and putting it into one offering. It is early days for premium levels of monetization, really only started in the last couple of years, and as customers go through the life cycle of a contract, more and more are trading up to these editions as they come up for renewal. It is not something that will be a big bang immediately overnight where everyone is on a premium edition, but rather as companies have other contracts rolling off from other vendors and consolidating onto Salesforce. The same is true on the Service Cloud side, where you have to have a case management solution, a telephony solution, and sometimes a chat or channel solution, with the same play being engineered on that side for more consolidation of extraneous spend into a consolidated Salesforce platform.
- **Q: Can you help put the different offerings into cohorts so we can understand what different customers should purchase?**
- A: With Agentforce 1 Edition, customers get Claudeforce, Agentforce, Data Cloud, and the best of all the Sales Cloud, with the goal being to have one edition that they all come into as a premium tier of all those offerings. Customers can buy all those items discretely, but Salesforce wants to make it an economically viable and attractive offering for companies to get the best of Salesforce in this one edition because for organizations running Agentforce 1 Edition, their salespeople are more productive and using the software more because they have Slack. The edition also includes the Tableau offering so they have all the analytics needed to be productive in their role, and this is really not just a strategy of loading someone up with all the Salesforce they could have but rather engineering this from the start to make it the best edition for workers to have the best performance of their lives.
- **Q: Explain the difference between Fin and Agentforce, as Fin in practice sounds a little bit like Agentforce in practice.**
- A: As the world of agents and agentic platforms are starting to clarify, it is becoming very clear that there are many customers that want to have purpose-built, specialized agents perform discrete tasks on behalf of their business. Fin is a solution engineered for the customer service domain to help streamline and automate a lot of routine interactions that a company has with its customers, making it a purposeful agent that is hyper-specialized and focused on that area.

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Piper, which is an agent from Qualified, is a hyper-focused, purpose-built agent for the marketing domain where Piper's job is to sit as part of a website, enroll someone through the sales and lead qualification process, and ultimately try to book meetings with sales professionals. These are two agents performing two very different tasks on top of commonly what might be a website experience from a company. Agentforce orchestrates all of them in the back end, understanding and knowing what Fin is doing, what Piper is doing, and what agents built by developers are doing on the platform so that one agent can start an experience and then pick it up as a conversation traverses from the marketing world to the selling world to the servicing world. It is overly reductive to say is it Qualified versus Agentforce or Piper versus Fin, as customers do not deploy one or the other but rather deploy all of them, starting with the top of the funnel with Piper, the bottom of the funnel with Fin, and Agentforce orchestrating in between.

- **Q: When I am on Agentforce 1, do I also have to budget for Anthropic token spend?**
- A: No, not on those offerings. If you are buying Claude as an Anthropic customer, you do that with Anthropic. As part of Agentforce and as part of Piper and as part of Fin, you are not paying for Anthropic tokens to make those interactions powered.
- **Q: Where does the budget come from when you are having conversations about selling outcomes and selling a unit of work?**
- A: It depends on where the outcomes are. Sometimes outcomes are actually aligned towards savings, so the actual savings become a self-fulfilling proposition where for every dollar saved, those dollars can be reinvested in the software that powers those savings. In other cases, some of the outcomes being worked on now, like in the case of sales and sales agent domain, involve paying for qualified leads or paying for orders that are actually booked. [

Call Participants

EXECUTIVES

Bill Patterson

President & Chief Commercial Officer

Rob Seaman
Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

Presentation

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Hey. Good afternoon and welcome to the Salesforce session at Goldman Sachs Communacopia. I'm Gabriela Borges. Delighted to have on stage with me Bill Patterson, President and Chief Commercial Officer; Rob Seaman, EVP and GM of Slack. Gentlemen, thank you for your time.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Thank you for having us today.

Question And Answer

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

So, Bill, I want to start out with a little bit of the mic drop moment from two weeks ago now with Dario and Marc on CNBC talking about the launch of Claudeforce. And it reminds me a little bit of when we were chatting with the management team earlier this year, they were telling us about the Anthropic SaaStr video where Anthropic talks about the cornerstone of their front office stack being Salesforce and all of the different pieces that they built on top of it. Tell us a little bit about how that relationship came together. And it sounds like you've essentially commercialized what would have taken a fair number of engineering resources to get off the ground. So we'd love to hear a little bit more.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah. Thank you for recognizing. That was two weeks ago, which seems like a decade--

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Yeah.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Ago now. But I think what's beautiful about the world of Claude and the world of Salesforce is our customers were naturally pulling us together to work together more effectively. And Salesforce is a huge Anthropic customer, and Anthropic is a huge Salesforce customer. So there's just natural synergies about these two technologies working together in unison to drive ultimately better quality agents, better productivity for every employee, and just better synergy on the product side. So it's always beautiful when -- we always say, the number one AI platform and the

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number one CRM platform can come together, because we can actually really validate a lot of the core use cases that we serve in common roles with one another in that sense.

So I think it was more than just an announcement. It was a product that was already being built, already being utilized, already being activated, already being deployed in almost every customer that we see today. And it was just a natural fit for these two product organizations to now work together and deliver product, which we now call Claudeforce. So I think this is just a classic example of two magical things coming together and delivering a great impact for our users. And we're very, very excited about the early days there.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Was there anything that you've learned in the last two weeks since making the announcement that was unexpected or that you hadn't predicted?

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Not unexpected, but I think that the market and the customer community probably breaks down into three tranches. One, there's a lot of just heavy early adopters that were really doing a lot of innovation and building a lot of these connections and integrations already themselves that validated the pattern for why we wanted to create a product in this area. And so, I think as part of that early adopter community, you got a lot of great feedback, a lot of validation, a lot of conviction about the magic of these two products becoming a strong partnership with one another.

I think as you fast-forward to the second tranche or second community of users, there are still those users today that are trying to figure out how to make this work and how to make it scale and how to make it economically viable for organizations of their size. Not every small business has an endless token budget, if you will. And so, really making sure that the economics work to drive the productivity and the performance of this offering is probably that second community of customers that now needs a little bit more knowledge and know how to make it work right.

And I think there's a third community that has a lot of skepticism around what does AI mean for them. And as you travel around the world in different communities, different geographies, not here in San Francisco per se, but as you go to other countries around the world, there is a little bit more AI hesitancy. And so, that is a final community that does need to be convinced that this is not a destructive force, it's actually a force to fundamentally transform work.

So I think as you take a long view around what the Claudeforce opportunity means, the early adopters are going to deploy it fast. Those that are trying to figure out the economics and the true math of how this works at scale, I think, are still need some convincing. And then that last tranche is an area that we have more responsibility as leaders to show them that this is a strong solution for their future and not, like I said, that cannibalistic force for eroding work as we know it.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Want to ask you about two of the bear cases that we've heard in the last two weeks. The first is the fox in the henhouse bear case, which is, look, tech partnerships come and go. They break down all the time. And essentially, through Claudeforce, Anthropic is now getting a foothold in the front office stacks of all of Salesforce's installed base. How do you think about the risk that however many years from now, Anthropic turns around and says, thank you, Salesforce, we're happy to take it from here?

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah. And look, I think that the fundamental mission of both organizations here is different from one another. The mission of Anthropic is really to prove that AI can have a really ubiquitous moment in our lives and our businesses. And the role of Salesforce is fundamentally to make businesses better businesses. So we have some relationship in that sense that we all want to help the customers that we serve. But in terms of the mission of what they innovate on and what we innovate on, they're very, very different technologies, very different pace of innovation and also better -- just different responsibilities of what we need customers to know, learn how to do and manage to be successful with these offerings.

There's been all kinds of new innovation that has always been the death of a CRM system at some point in time. The first one was like a website. Oh my God, that's going to eliminate how we do marketing and marketing outreach. It didn't transform. It didn't do away with CRM. I mean it just transformed CRM to be a world of outside in engagement just as much as it's been about inside out operational responsibility. So I think there's a long list of companies and a long list of technologies that were trying to kill the CRM business. We're still here. We're doing well.

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Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

The second bear case, and we can bring Rob into the conversation naturally with this one, is the idea that Salesforce is essentially giving up the user interface. So the end customer now interacts with Claude. Claude is their first port of call and Salesforce essentially becomes this Satya Nadella CRUD database argument from 18 months ago now. How would you respond to that particular UI bear case?

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

I'd go about it from the perspective, one, I don't agree with it. I'd start with that. So I think minimizing Salesforce or CRM in general to a database, I think, is somewhat glib and a bit of an oversight into what's actually happened in CRM systems. So much of what people have done is express how their company operates in the form of metadata in Salesforce and their CRM. And that candidly just isn't very replicable. And that's what people are excited about accessing through other services like Claudeforce or Slack or whatever it might be.

Now, on the argument about giving up the user interface, while you may be giving up a bit on the amount of time people spend in the interface, you're actually increasing the amount of work that's happening through the services that support the interfaces. And to me, that's the bigger bet is that ultimately more work gets done through our CRM system. If you look at our own internal data on our usage of Salesforce, our usage of Salesforce has skyrocketed within Salesforce, but the overwhelming majority of it's happening through Slack and through Claude. And so the amount of work that's actually happening and the quality of work that's happening has dramatically skyrocketed. And our productivity has improved, as you've seen through our financial metrics. But it's all because we've moved to this headless manner in a way, I think, that tilts the umbrella and makes it a lot more convenient for users to get the work done.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Tell us a little bit more. You've talked about Slack as the operating system for work. What does that look like? What does it mean for your R&D roadmap to now be investing in Slack not just as a communications tool, but as this essential gateway to all of the underlying system of record?

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

Yeah. So when we think – so the biggest asset we have at Slack is the aggregated attention of knowledge workers. So the average Slack user actually has the Slack app open 10 hours a day and actively uses it 2 hours a day. So if it were a consumer app, it would be a great place to put ads. But we will never put ads in Slack, so do not expect that to come from us. It becomes an amazing place to distribute your software. So B2B software is increasingly being distributed through Slack as agents are. Now, when you increase the amount of stuff that is coming at humans, humans can become distracted and that defeats the purpose of that attention aggregation.

And so what we think the role that we can play is if you go look – if you go back to the original operating systems and what they did, they basically abstracted or hid the complexity of the hardware from the end user and typically had a user interface paradigm about it. That's effectively what Slack does for a litany of apps and agents that are now coming at people in addition to the humans that are reaching out to them.

So, from an operating system perspective, we think we can basically provide that overall design guideline and system that apps and agents can adhere to. We can abstract the complexity of the fact that there are thousands of them now competing for people's attention and make it a single place that people can orchestrate their day and be a cockpit of. And so I think we ultimately become where the AI stack starts and stops.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

You gave an example there of where it's been successful within the own Salesforce organization. And I imagine you have customers that you would classify as top quartile in terms of early adopters of Slack functionality. My question for you is what are the alternatives for the customers that maybe we separate out the cohort that's still hesitant? For the customers that are leaning into AI that are not using Slack as one of their primary user interfaces, what does that look like? What's the alternative?

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

I mean the alternative is alternatives from competing products that I think are functionally deficient. And so I think that the key thing about Slack, and I think you see this play out in all the major AI companies that use Slack. And I apologize in advance if I'm saying something that I – to whoever, if I'm saying something that I'm not supposed to. But if you look at Anthropic, you look at OpenAI, you look at Vercel, all of these frontier labs and AI-first companies

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operate their Slack in a very unique way, which is they operate totally in public. I was talking to Boris from Anthropic yesterday. It was so fascinating. Every single Anthropic employee has a notebook channel. It's basically a channel with themselves where they just think out loud through the course of the day. They do this. OpenAI does this. Vercel does this. We do it at Slack.

And what that does is that radically flattens an organization and immediately disseminates all information from that person to every other person in the company, but importantly, to all the other agents. And that model in Slack, and the way that the software actually encourages people to participate in a very social way, in a very public way, is not something you see happen in the alternatives that are out there today, full stop. I would challenge anybody to go talk to a customer that's using an alternative product and ask them how they do that, and they'll just stare at you like you have 10 heads or you--

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Rob, you got to stay on this. This is a really interesting rabbit hole. So what is Anthropic doing with Slack that allows them to power this army of agents behind the interface? Tell us a little bit more about [Indiscernible].

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

They do as much as humanly possible in public. So every single product channel, feature channel, is public for the entire company to access and all the agents to access. Every single person then has what we call a notebook or brain channel. Vercel does a similar thing. If you talk to [G] from Vercel, they have a brain channel and they just think out loud in these brain channels. And so everybody in the company can see what G is thinking, and every agent that's in your Slack can see what G is thinking because it's public.

And I think increasingly, if you look at what Tobi Lütke – I don't know if I'm pronouncing that right, the CEO of Shopify. He wrote a piece on Twitter called Learning on the Shop Floor, and it was about using their River agent in Slack, but only doing so in public. And what's interesting is they've deployed their coding agent, River, which is built on top of another harness, but they've deployed it in Slack and only allow it to be used in public channels in Slack. And so what you're doing there is you're effectively immediately disseminating to the entire company every single thing that's being built.

So everybody can just search and be like, is somebody else working on this yet? So you radically reduce duplication of effort, but then you also learn from each other. Like the bear case to me on these individual contributor AI tools is that, and Tobi says this as well, is that the AI learns and the person using it learns, but their peer doesn't learn, and then the company doesn't learn from it. But you move that into public, like in a channel in Slack, and then everybody else can learn from it. It immediately becomes a knowledge artifact for your employees, but also for other agents in your Slack.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Okay. So you've already given us one of the answers to this question on why Slack is the natural place for that activity to happen, which is it's already open 10 hours a day, it's active 2 hours a day. What else is in the IP of Slack that you think allows that use case to flourish?

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

I mean, some of it comes down to how we work. People are – so one of the things we've traditionally said about Slack behind the scenes is our enduring competitive advantage is going to be the quality of our user experience and the customer love that we generate from that user experience. And the fact of the matter is, we have a really high NPS. Customers love to use our stuff. They tell their friends about it. It's viral. It takes off within a market. And so when people are asking their company for access to software, they're like, hey, can you put this thing in Slack? So we've been able to develop this groundswell and grassroots support and pull from our users. I think that it's really, really helping us right now. You saw it play out at a large social networking company last week. So--

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

This opens up an interesting thread here on monetization, and I'll ask it in a couple of different ways. So, first with Slack. Historically, it's been a seat count model.

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

Per user per month, yeah.

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Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Per user per month. And now, you have any given user getting boatloads more value, especially for the AI [pilot] examples that you gave there. How does the pricing model change for the Shopify users of the world?

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

Yeah. So it's interesting. So we have – and Bill, obviously feel free to chime in here. We have a series of plans. So we, I think, have been one of the more successful premium products that we still have the overwhelming majority of what we call our invoice business, which is our sales business or enterprise sales business, initiates as what we call self-serve. So you start as a free team, you grow up through our plan, through nudges in the product to use more features of the product, start paying for it and then eventually convert over into what we call an invoice enterprise plan that our salespeople help you with.

From a monetization perspective, I think there's a couple things that we can do here. So one, the overall – the total TAM for knowledge workers is around $1 billion at this point. So I think we still have a ton of upside as it relates to user acquisition. But increasingly, I think you're going to see more agents in Slack than you see humans. And that creates a fascinating monetization opportunity that we haven't totally cracked the nut yet on, but I think it creates incredible upside for Salesforce. And so you can think of agents potentially as users, you can think of consumption-based mechanisms for monetization as agents – actually, the access patterns for information in Slack by agents are very different than that from humans. And so we're in the early stages of that. But I could not be more excited about the upside for Slack.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah. And I'll build on that, Rob. I think as Rob mentioned, what started as largely per user per month is now expanding into the agents that are exploding in the workforce, the usage that's exploding like never before. And even into the future, you're going to start to see more things like outcomes that organizations are ruminating on or delivering with Slack at the cortex of that work that really become opportunities for participating in more value exchange between us and the customers that we serve.

So, as you think about the monetization opportunities, they're highly elastic, and they're highly variable based on what companies do with the software. And what is really fascinating about Slack is how much people do with the software and how we all embrace it in our core work and workflow. And it just becomes almost like the place where I prefer to do my work as opposed to all these other systems I might have had to interface to do my job with prior. So I think the monetization opportunity, it started very small around the user base world, now expands into lots of different upside potential for many of our businesses, Slack included.

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

And that I think goes back to something you asked earlier that I didn't perfectly answer when you were talking about our differentiation or how we might maintain this. I think that's our moat, honestly, is the distribution that we've had, the compounding context flywheel that sits in Slack and just the more and more you use it, the more and more valuable it becomes. And I think that's ultimately the moat.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Bill, I want to ask you a couple of broader monetization questions. The data point we got from Miguel on the earnings call was 5% roughly of the Salesforce installed base is on premium SKU.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

And premium SKU can sometimes be a 60% to 80% uplift. Could you just break this down for us a little bit? If we're a Salesforce customer and we're not one of the ones that have already invested engineering resources into making Claudeforce happen without Claudeforce and we say Claudeforce sounds amazing, how soon can we onboard? What is – explain the 60% to 80% a little bit more. What is that uplift?

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah. Let me give you, in the case of our traditional two Core Cloud, Sales Cloud and Service Cloud. But when you think about all the software that's required to make a salesperson productive, not only is oftentimes your CRM

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system for managing your sales pipeline, your contacts, your accounts, et cetera, but that often expands into your sales performance management system, where my quota, where my commission, where my compensation management systems are aligned, maybe my sales enablement software, which is to help me become enabled or effective as a seller, maybe that's where all my content exists, so I can came out and deliver pitches or proposals to my customers. And there's also all these externally -- sometimes it's call recording software or coaching software that helps me in moments of working with customers.

Well, the average spend on a customer with all of those other technologies in the United States is about $1,300 for an average sales professional. And what we've been able to do is put a lot of this value into one price edition called our Agentforce 1 Edition, or we may have a new name for that next week, but I'll call Agentforce 1 Edition today. That Agentforce 1 Edition retails for $550. So the goal here is to really take money out of the extremities, where we know every sales organization has to recruit, hire, activate, and make salespeople productive and performant and now put it into one offering that's there.

And it's early days for us. We only started really thinking about premium levels of monetization really in the last couple years. And so, as Miguel was rightfully pointing out, it's just early days for us to put these premium editions into our installed base. And as they go through the life cycle of a contract with our company, what we're seeing is more and more of our customers are trading up to these editions as they come up for renewal.

So it's not something that will be a big bang immediately overnight is everyone on a premium edition. It is something that, as companies have other contracts that they're rolling off from other vendors and now consolidating onto Salesforce. That's the motion that we're running with the premium editions that are there. And I think it really allows our customers to save money in the process while driving higher performance and higher productivity for every salesperson that they have.

By the way, the same is true on the Service Cloud side. You have to have a case management solution, a telephony solution, sometimes a chat or channel solution that's out there. And so the same play is what we're engineering on that side, which is more consolidation of extraneous spend into more of a consolidated Salesforce platform.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

So there theoretically will be an upgrade cycle that we could guess at for each of the Salesforce clouds over time. That is essentially the strategy you talked about.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

The thing that I want to better understand – so this can get pretty confusing pretty quickly because you've got the Agentforce SKU, you've got what will be the Claudeforce SKU. You've got Headless, which is a pick and mix independent of Anthropic. Maybe just help – you had a beautiful cohort description earlier. Help us put this into cohorts so we can understand what the different customers--

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

You're doing a pretty good job with all the names. And so, like I said, the naming is something that we're definitely working through as a team. But let me make it really simple.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Please.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

With our Agentforce 1 Edition, you get Claudeforce, you get Agentforce, you get Data Cloud and you get the best of all the Sales Cloud that's there. So we want to have one edition that they all come into--

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Super tier.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

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Yes. Exactly, a premium tier of all of those offerings. Now, can you buy all of those items discreetly? Yes, you can buy all those items discreetly. But we want to make it an economically viable and attractive offering for companies to get the best of Salesforce in this one edition because what you know is that for those organizations that run that Agentforce 1 Edition, their salespeople are more productive, they're using the software more because they have Slack. Also into that edition, they have our Tableau offering. So they have all the analytics that they need to be productive in their role. And so this is really not just a strategy of loading someone up with all the Salesforce that they could have. It's really, we've engineered this from the start to make it the best edition for workers to have the best performance of their lives.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

And that is the 60% to 80% or map it back to--

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

That's right. That would be where that number would correlate to.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Okay. Now, let's introduce Fin and Qualified into the equation. One of the nuances that we struggle with a little bit is Fin in practice sounds a little bit like Agentforce in practice, but it's not. Explain the difference.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah. So, I think as the world of agents and agentic platforms are starting to clarify for all of us, it's become very clear that there are many customers that want to have purpose-built, specialized agents perform discrete tasks on behalf of their business. Fin is a great example. Fin is a solution that was engineered for the customer service domain really to help streamline and automate a lot of those routines and interactions that a company has with its customers. And so that is – Fin is a purposeful agent that is hyper-specialized and focused on that area.

Piper, which is an agent from Qualified, is actually a hyper-focused, purpose-built agent for the marketing domain where Piper's job is to sit as part of your website, enroll someone through your sales and lead qualification process, and ultimately, try and book meetings with sales professionals. So these are two agents and two very different tasks on top of commonly what might be a website experience from a company.

Now, what Agentforce does is it orchestrates all of them in the back end. It understands and knows what Fin is doing. It knows and understands what Piper is doing. It knows and understands what agents that are built by developers are doing on this platform so that we know that one agent can start an experience and then pick it up as a conversation traverses from the marketing world to the selling world to the servicing world. And so this is where, again, as the world between platforms that orchestrate the journey and agents that power the front end of those experiences, that's how they differentiate from one another. But it's overly probably reductive to say is it Qualified versus Agentforce or Piper versus Fin. We don't see customers say I deploy one or the other. Oftentimes what we see are companies deploy all of them. They start with the top of the funnel with a Piper, the bottom of the funnel with a Fin, and our Agentforce orchestrates in between.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

And then I also have to budget to Anthropic token spend.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Not on those offerings.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

When I'm on Agentforce 1, sorry.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah. No, not on those offerings. If you're buying Claude as or Anthropic as a customer, you do that with them, with Anthropic. As part of Agentforce and as part of Piper and as part of Fin, you're not paying for Anthropic tokens to make those interactions powered.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

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Okay. That makes sense. Let me ask the broader question, which is there's an evolution in software here that goes from being seat count-based to selling outcomes, selling a unit of work which we think is quite expansionary for the software TAM. Where does the budget come from when you're having these conversations?

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah. Well, I think maybe I'll start and Rob, you can add in from your productivity lens, but I think as terms of budget goes, it depends on where the outcomes are. Sometimes outcomes are actually aligned towards savings. So the actual savings become a self-fulfilling proposition. For every dollar $1 we save, we can reinvest those dollars in the software that powers those savings. And in other cases, some of the outcomes that we're working on now, like in the case of our sales and sales agent domain, paying for qualified leads or paying for orders that are actually booked. And so that's where organizations are happy to invest in those ***outcome-based*** ***agents*** because the more that those ***agents*** perform, the higher revenue that they're actually performing for their organization.

So I would say that the ***outcome-based*** ***agents*** actually allow us to align value realized with budgetary planning altogether. I've not yet met a CFO that says I'm not willing to give you $1 if you're actually going to help me make $3. So this is an opportunity for us to, like you said, get into more of that expansionary opportunity, especially as our benefits are more jointly aligned with customers on those domains specifically.

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

I mean I would layer in. We continue to see more and more of a premium for Slack because of the additional work that we're taking on and the economics we're helping our customers with. So we're a little bit different. So, when you were talking about in general the move to Headless and Claudeforce as an example earlier, within Slack, we have something called Slackbot, which is an out-of-the-box agent for knowledge workers that is built on top of Anthropic.

And at the broader Salesforce level, we think it's important that you be able to accomplish the work through whatever your tool of choice might be. So we want to be able to tie into any harness that you use, but we are going to have an opinionated harness out of the box and that is Slackbot. And so, when we look at Slackbot, one of the bets that we make is we actually take on the burden of token economics ourselves.

And so, as part of the per user per month seat for our highest grade plan, our knowledge workers that our customers are able to go to Slackbot and get done much of what they might have done in an open-ended cost tool in another way. And does it mean those other things can go away? No, it doesn't. It means it's an easier way to budget and some of the more specific, higher order, like deep knowledge work that needs to happen in those other tools will happen over there. But this is just like a very easy, reliable way for you to give a knowledge work agent to the majority of your employees at a reliable cost and then really target, yeah, they need Claude Code or they need Coworker, they need an unlimited token spend, et cetera.

But we see often the premium that we're getting coming at the expense of utilization of other tools, frankly. And it's not necessarily elimination of heads. When you look at Slack, we'll have a business leader bring Slack into an organization like a sales organization. They'll be like, okay, I want to connect Slack to Salesforce and I have a goal of getting my first sales reps – my new sales reps to productive in 90 days or less. It used to take six months. And you connect Salesforce and Slack together, and they can do that, and they're effectively accelerating revenue rather than – and taking some cost out because they aren't using third parties to come in and train those people. They're actually having the software do it for them or it's like, okay, we're doing a percentage of our internal meetings through huddles now, as opposed to these other things that we're doing. So we're shaking 30% of the workload off of some of those other tools. Similar things with documents, similar things with agents for knowledge workers. So we shave off by being more convenient. Economics in other places.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

I have two big picture software questions I want to pick your brain on. So the first is, Bill, you've talked in the past about back office versus front office convergence and how agents can perhaps blur the lines. What do you think is the future of what has historically been silos between back and front office?

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah. I started my career as a production scheduler for Motorola as an intern. And so I was like a back office dude. And then I learned about this magical thing called CRM, which is about actually working with customers. And so I've always had this inner rift in my own brain between back office and front office. And what was fascinating is the limits of the technology systems have always been really about the roles that were specialized to perform discrete tasks and functions. And when you learn about a lot of the systems in use for many businesses, those systems

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themselves were operationalized or built for the constraint of what human labor could do. And so I think it's so fascinating right now.

And Rob, you talked about it and alluded to it with the Slack world, we'll see more agents in our workplace than employees and human employees sometimes in our workplace to perform work and tasks. And so we have to go back to the ability to reinvent a lot of these fundamental systems and processes and activities that people do because now the technology is going to be always on, always running in our lives really to help us become more productive and to drive higher-quality output in the work that we perform.

So if anyone here is a back office and front office maven, I'm sorry to say I think they'll blend. And I think that they will blend in ways that really break down a lot of categories and a lot of opportunities. But at the end of the day, if we use software to make companies perform better, that's where value systems like Salesforce are really being engineered for from day one, which is to help make our companies be better companies, help them engage their customers in better ways and help them transform their business not to recreate yesterday's legacy, but really to define what tomorrow looks like. So I'm very, very bullish about just workplace and workforce transformation in that regard. I never want to have to do MRP scheduling again in my life. And so I'm very, very excited about this ability to fundamentally hand some of that work to agents and to spend energy where I like to spend energy, which is with people and relating in new and exciting ways.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Okay. So the second one is horizontal versus vertical. And you'll have some pretty spicy comments from David Friedberg at the beginning of the earnings call on horizontal leading vertical. You've announced some really interesting life sciences wins. For either of you, what do you think is the future of vertical software?

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

Maybe I can start--

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Yeah. Perfect.

Rob Seaman, Executive Vice President & General Manager, Slack

Because I think Slack is inherently more horizontal, I think, than the rest of the Salesforce products. But I think there are opportunities for us to get more vertical, and I think maybe that'll be a good segue to Bill. But again, coming back to the total available market for knowledge workers, it's in excess of 1 billion people, I think globally. So we very much look at the horizontal opportunity for Slack. Because what's been very interesting is if you look at – from the inception of Slack, the challenge that was set forth for the team was, is there a way that we can build software that will make coordination easier, to make people – the hardest part of people's working lives, coordination more simple, pleasant and productive? And that's a problem space that fortunately has endured pretty tectonic shifts in underlying technologies, whether that be the cloud substrates to now the new models. Coordination is still a pain in the ass. I don't know if anybody's ever read Komoroske's Komarovsky's Slime Molds article, go read that. And I think there just remains tremendous horizontal opportunity for coordination and orchestration of work for knowledge workers despite everything that's happening with agents that are out there today.

I think there are domains that we can verticalize in that we're interested in. You're starting to see us do with Slack Code, which is we can – that span industry verticals. And so I think you'll see us go in the stovepipes of LOBs rather than necessarily industry verticals. But I think you can expect to see us go long on tech and dev and coding, in particular, from a verticalization perspective.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Yeah, in the spicy commentary, I think really the message was about finding out where really your true differentiation, your ability to create unique values represents. And if you keep going down that spectrum, there's horizontal and then there's vertical and then there's regional and then there's local and then there's personal opportunities to create value along that spectrum. And I don't think that value stops on any one of those stops along the journey.

I do think there's immense opportunity for us to utilize the technology. And I think I take a lot of inspiration for what Slack does for me in my life, where I get out of my own way and I work with my team and I work with my group and I work with my organization in ways that I never could do before. But that just goes on that same spectrum, where I'm now working less in a local way, but more in a communal way.

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And I think that as we see this vertical opportunity maybe more clearly, there is great value that we can create making hyper-relevant computing for companies in certain industries that maybe have regulatory requirements and uniqueness that allows us to maybe deliver higher-value services to them or not. So I'm not a big believer in the versus. I think there's a big spectrum of opportunity there, and we're excited to play in that spectrum, broadly speaking.

Gabriela Borges, Analyst, Goldman Sachs

Hey. It's really good stuff. Please join me in thanking Bill and Rob for their time. Thank you, guys.

Bill Patterson, President & Chief Commercial Officer

Thank you.

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